

Statistical Inference Essentials

Mastering the Central Limit Theorem & Chi-Square Tests

Central Limit Theorem: The distribution of sample means approximates a normal distribution as sample size increases, regardless of the population's distribution, enabling reliable inference on continuous data.

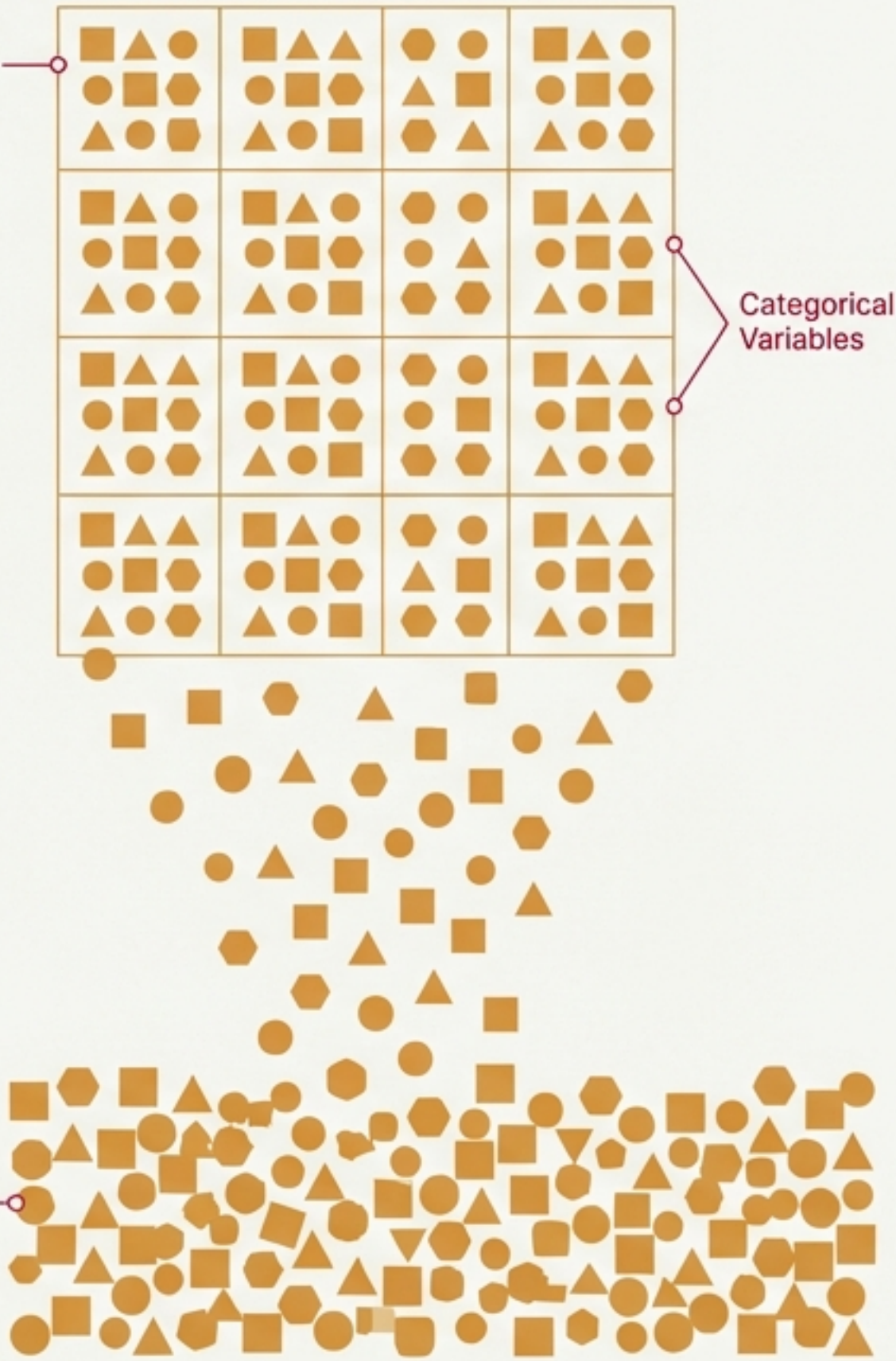
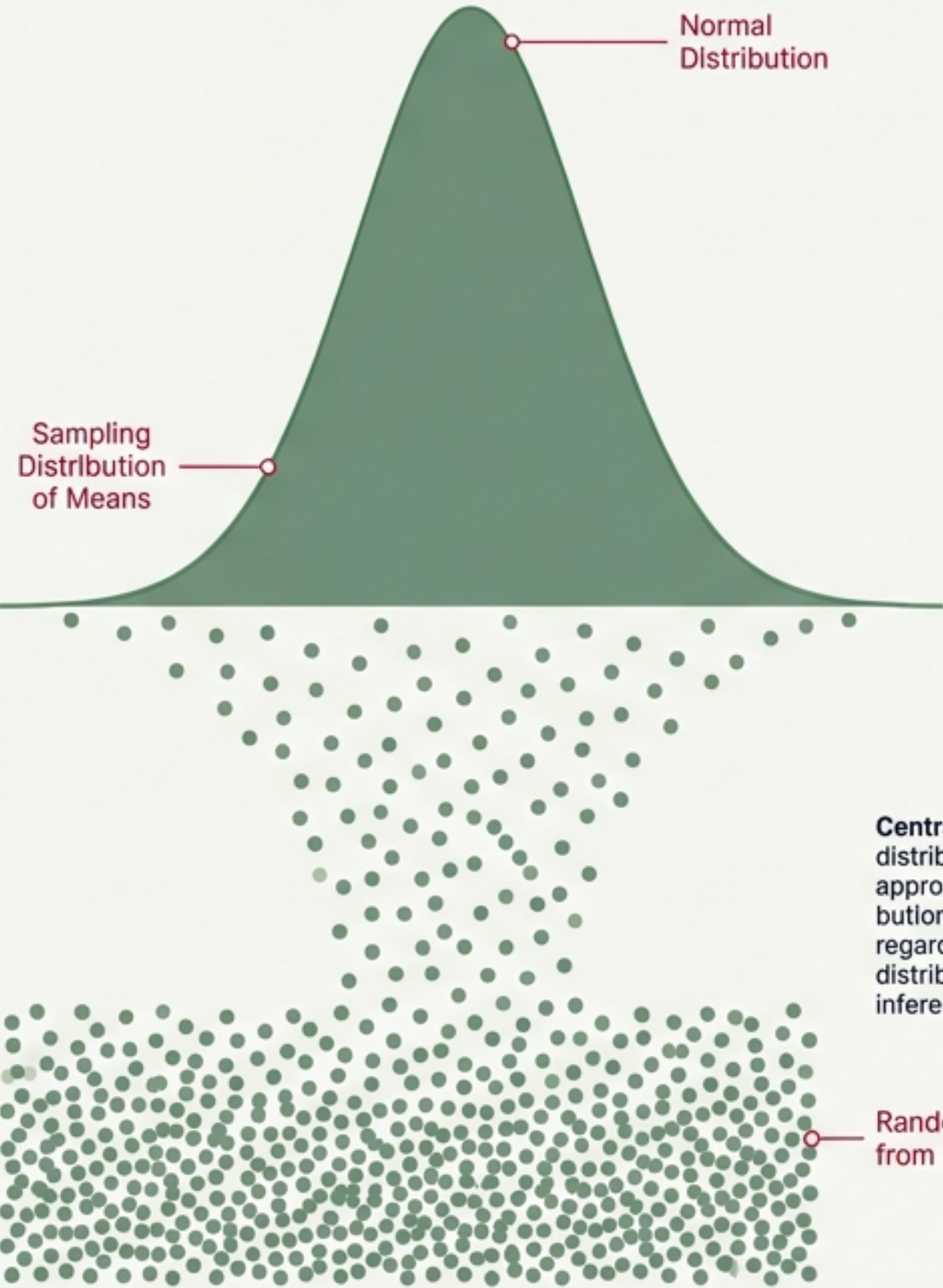
Chi-Square Tests: Assess the association or independence between categorical variables by comparing observed frequencies to expected frequencies, identifying significant patterns in categorical data.

Random Sampling from Population

Observed Frequency Data

Contingency Table (4x4 Matrix)

Categorical Variables



From Randomness to Reliability

Making Sense of Randomness

Data is naturally messy. To find the signal in the noise, we rely on two pillars of statistical inference.

Continuous Data



Tool: Central Limit Theorem (CLT)

Application: Making population inferences from samples.

Categorical Data



Tool: Chi-Square Tests

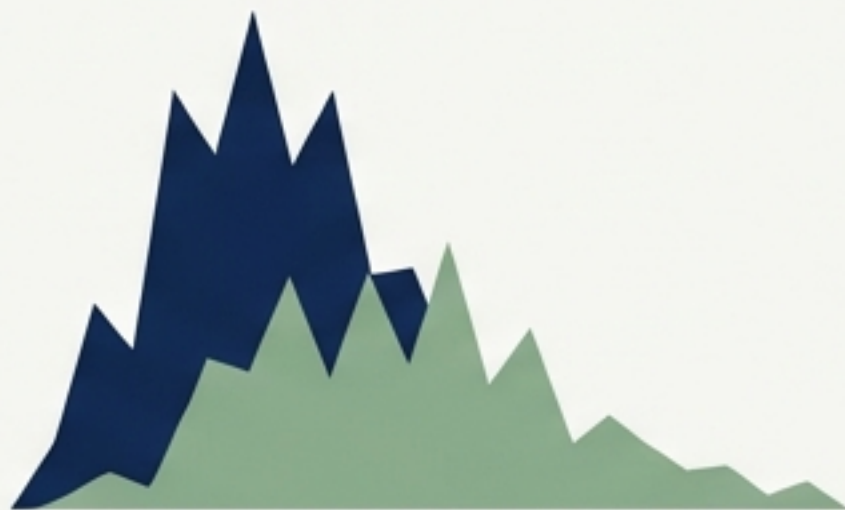
Application: Determining associations and goodness of fit.

Key Insight:

These methodologies form the backbone of A/B testing, predictive modelling, and hypothesis testing.

The Power of the Sample

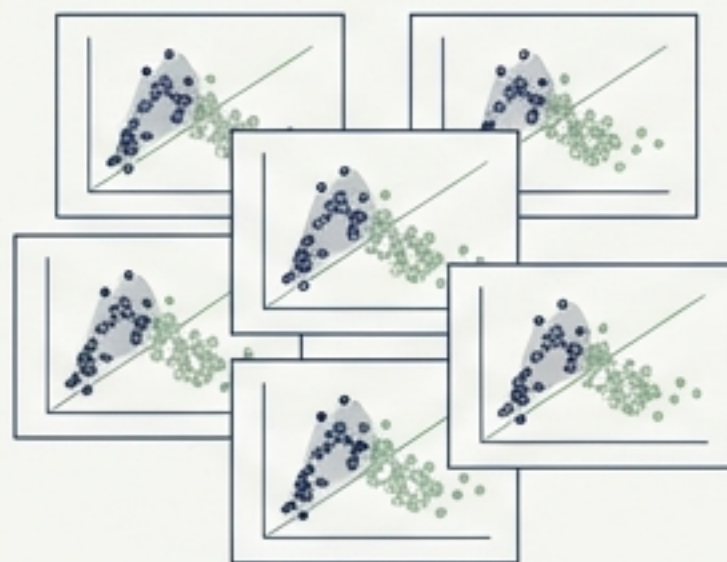
Any Population Distribution
(Skewed/Weird)



Sampling
Process



Magic Threshold: $n \geq 30$
Inter Tight



Sampling Distribution
of the Mean



The Central Limit Theorem (CLT) states that when we take random samples of a sufficiently large size ($n \geq 30$) from any population distribution, the sampling distribution of the sample mean will approximate a normal distribution.

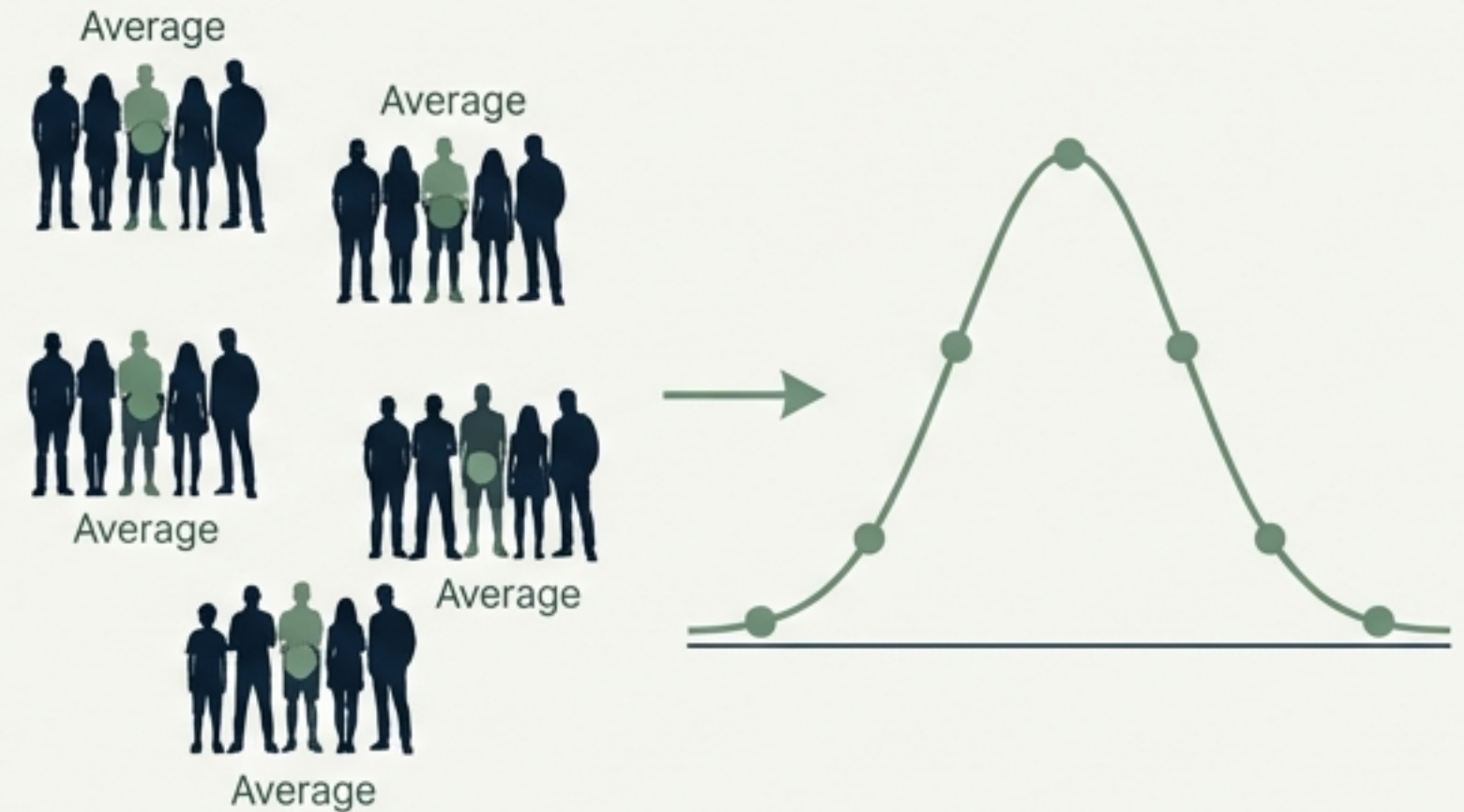
$$SE = \frac{\sigma}{\sqrt{n}}$$

Why CLT Matters in Data Science

The Reality: Student Heights



The Inference



Inference

Estimate population parameters from small samples.

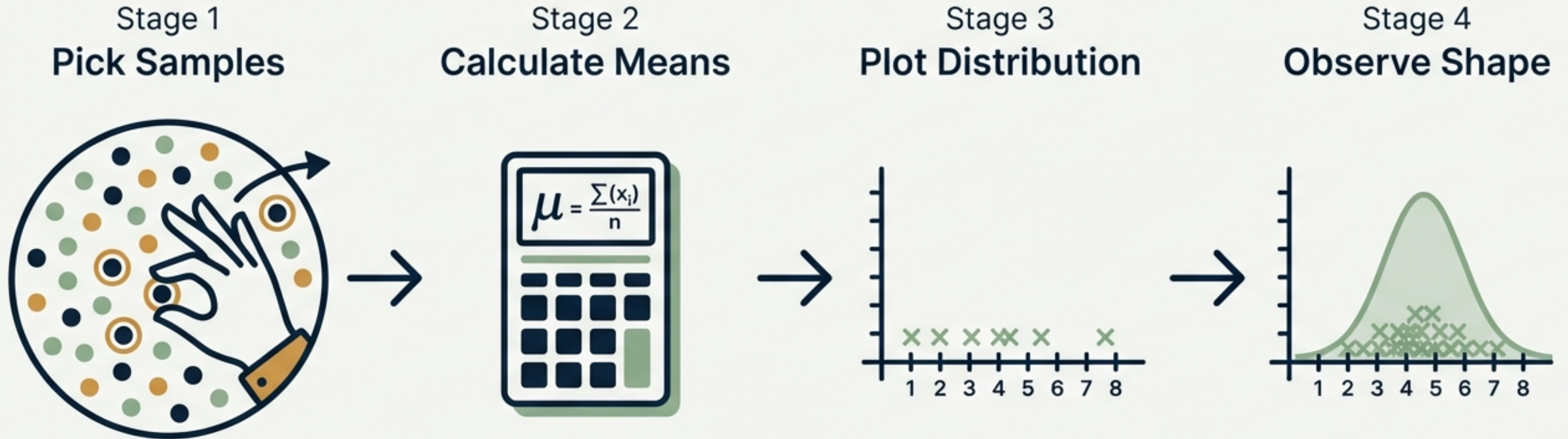
Tools

Unlocks Z-scores, Confidence Intervals, and T-tests on non-normal data.

Testing

Essential for Hypothesis Testing and A/B Testing conversion rates.

The Sampling Process Step-by-Step

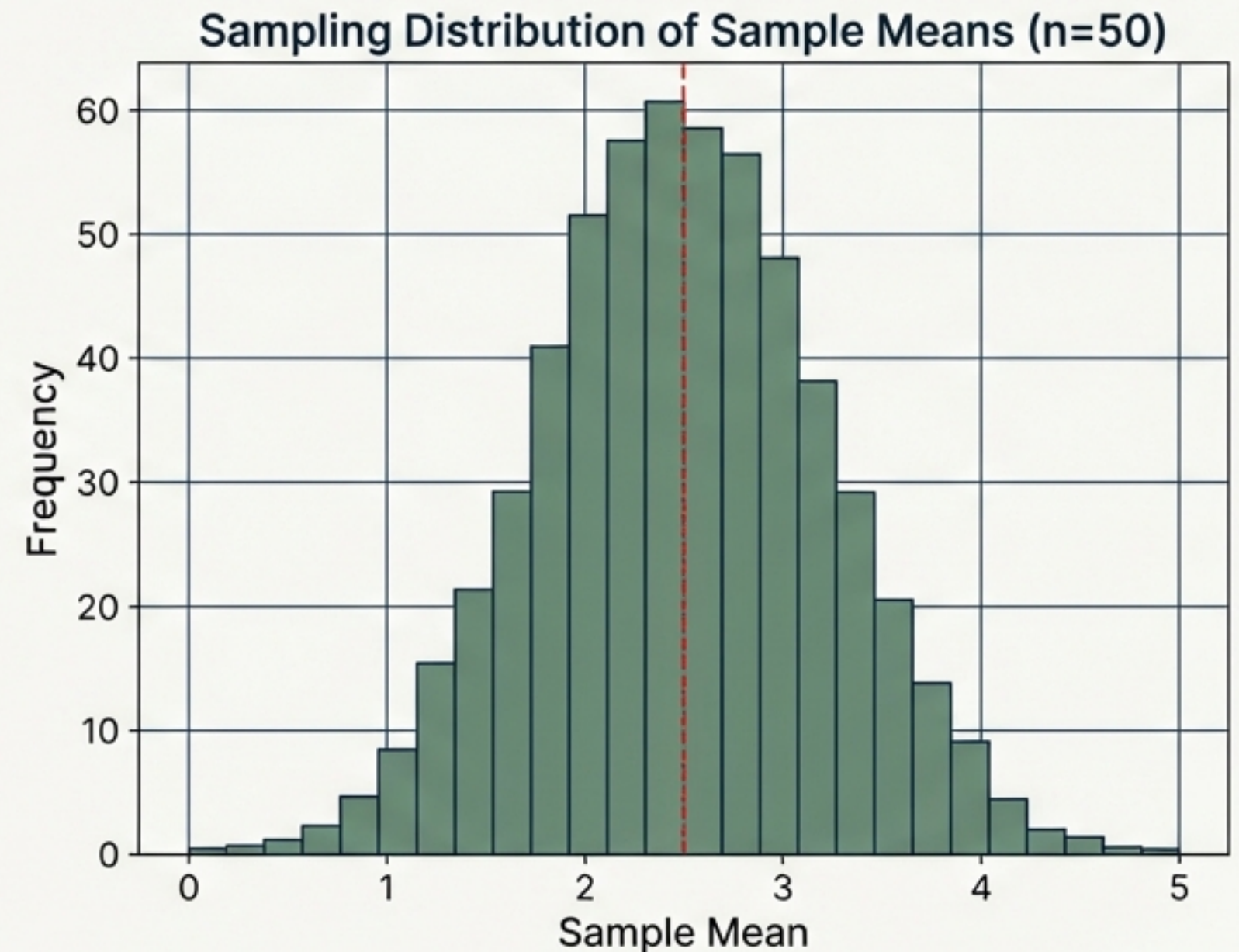


Note on Prediction

Predictive modelling assumes error terms are normally distributed, a property often justified by CLT.

Simulating CLT in Python

```
population = np.random.exponential(scale=2,  
size=100000)  
  
sample_means = []  
  
for _ in range(1000):  
    sample = np.random.choice(population,  
size=50)  
    sample_means.append(np.mean(sample))  
  
plt.hist(sample_means, bins=30)
```



Analysing Categorical Data

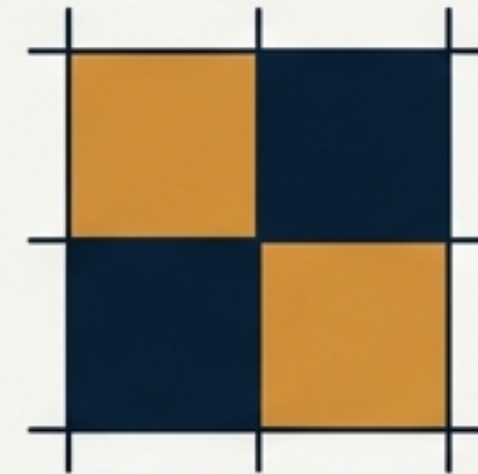
When data is not numerical (like height) but categorical (Yes/No, Red/Blue), we cannot use CLT.
We use Chi-Square.

Goodness of Fit



Tests if observed frequencies match expected frequencies (1 variable)

Test of Independence



Tests if two variables are related (2 variables)

Type I: Goodness of Fit Test

The “Fairness” Test

$$\chi^2 = \sum \frac{(O_i - E_i)^2}{E_i}$$

Observed Frequency
Crimson Pro
(What actually happened)

Expected Frequency
(Theory/Hypothesis)

The test sums the squared differences. If Observed and Expected are close, the result is small (Good Fit). If distinct, the result is large (Bad Fit).

Example: Is the Die Fair?



The Calculation

$$\chi^2 = \frac{(10 - 10)^2}{10} + \frac{(8 - 10)^2}{10} + \dots + \frac{(10 - 10)^2}{10}$$
$$= 0 + 0.4 + 0.4 + 0.1 + 0.1 + 0 = 1.0$$

Chi-Square = 1.0

Face	1	2	3	4	5	6
Observed - 60 rolls	10	8	12	11	9	10
Expected - Theory	10	10	10	10	10	10

Decision Logic:

Critical Value (df=5, α=0.05) = 11.07

1.0 < 11.07 -> Fail to Reject Null Hypothesis.

Conclusion: The die appears fair.

Goodness of Fit in Python

Python Implementation

```
from scipy.stats import chisquare

observed = [10, 8, 12, 11, 9, 10]
expected = [10] * 6

chi_stat, p_value =
chisquare(f_obs=observed,
f_exp=expected)
```

Test Results

```
>>> Chi-square statistic: 1.0
>>> p-value: 0.96 (High)
```

Conclusion: No significant difference.

Type II: Test of Independence

The “Relationship” Test

Row Variable	Column Variable		
			T
	A1	A2	AT
	B1	B2	BT
T	AT	CT	GT

Purpose: Tests if Variable A influences Variable B.

The Math

The test statistic is the same, but the Expected Frequency calculation changes.

$$E_{ij} = \frac{\text{Row Total} \times \text{Col Total}}{\text{Grand Total}}$$

Example: Gender vs. Drink Preference

Does gender influence the choice between Tea or Coffee?

	Tea	Coffee	
Male	30	20	Row Total
Female	10	40	Row Total
	40	60	Grand Total
		Column Total	

Calculating Independence

Step 1: Expected Frequencies

$$E_{\text{Male, Tea}} = \frac{50 \times 40}{100} = 20$$

Step 2: Chi-Square Statistic

$$\begin{aligned}\chi^2 &= \sum \frac{(\text{Observed} - \text{Expected})^2}{\text{Expected}} = \frac{(30 - 20)^2}{20} + \frac{(20 - 30)^2}{30} + \frac{(10 - 20)^2}{20} + \frac{(40 - 30)^2}{30} \\ &= (100/20) + (100/30) + (100/20) + (100/30) = 5 + 3.33 + 5 + 3.33 = 16.66\end{aligned}$$

Result: Chi-Square = 16.66

Decision

Critical Value (df=1, $\alpha=0.05$) = 3.84

16.66 > 3.84 → Reject Null Hypothesis.

Conclusion: Strong association exists between gender and preference.

Test of Independence in Python

```
import pandas as pd
from scipy.stats import
chi2_contingency
```

```
data = [[30, 20], [10, 40]]
df = pd.DataFrame(data, columns=['Tea',
'Coffee'], index=['Male', 'Female'])
```

```
chi2, p, dof, expected =
chi2_contingency(df)
```

```
>>> Chi-square statistic: 16.66
```

```
>>> p-value: 0.00004 (Significant)
```

Conclusion: **Reject Null Hypothesis.**

The Inference Decision Matrix

